

English Language Arts

CRITICAL THINKING



SKILLS FOR STUDENTS

Grade 10

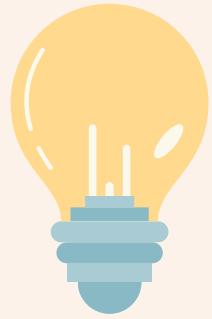


LESSON OUTLINE

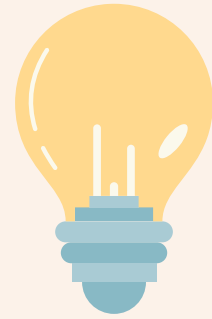


- 01 What Is Critical Thinking
- 02 Characteristics of Critical Thinkers
- 03 Importance of Critical Thinking
- 04 Skill Development

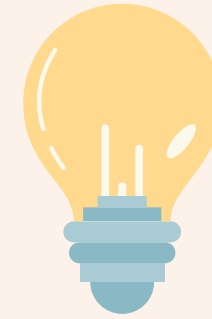
Learning Outcomes



The ability to define
critical thinking



Understanding
characteristics of
critical thinkers



Applying skills to
schoolwork and
decision-making

What Is Critical Thinking?



Critical thinking is the ability to analyze information objectively and make a judgment or decision.

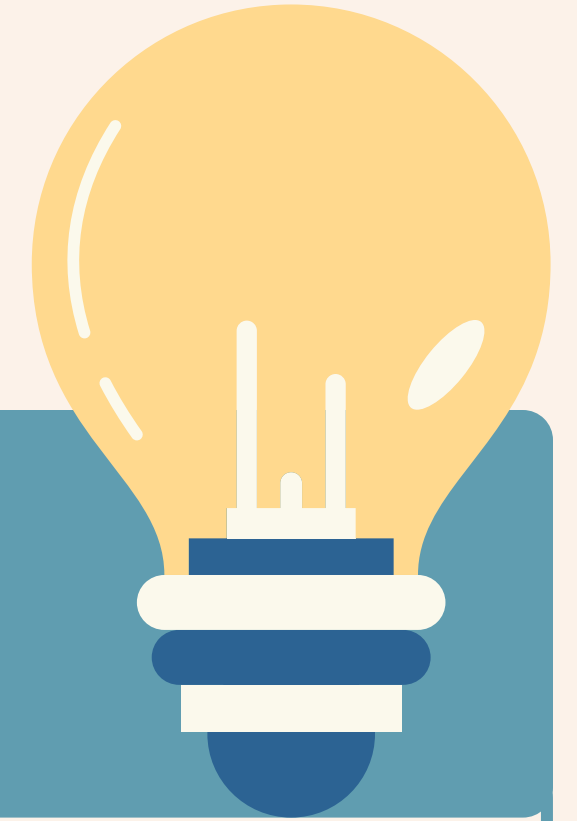
It is purposeful, logical, balanced, and considers all parts of the problem.

Through critical thinking we achieve an in-depth understanding of the world by being engaged and curious when learning.



Opening Question

If you could be the creator of any invention in history (but you don't receive any money for it), what would it be and why?



Type answer here

4

Characteristics of CRITICAL THINKERS



- 01 Having an Open Mindset
- 02 Looking for Evidence and Reasoning
- 03 Recognizing Bias
- 04 Striving for Understanding

01

Having an Open Mindset



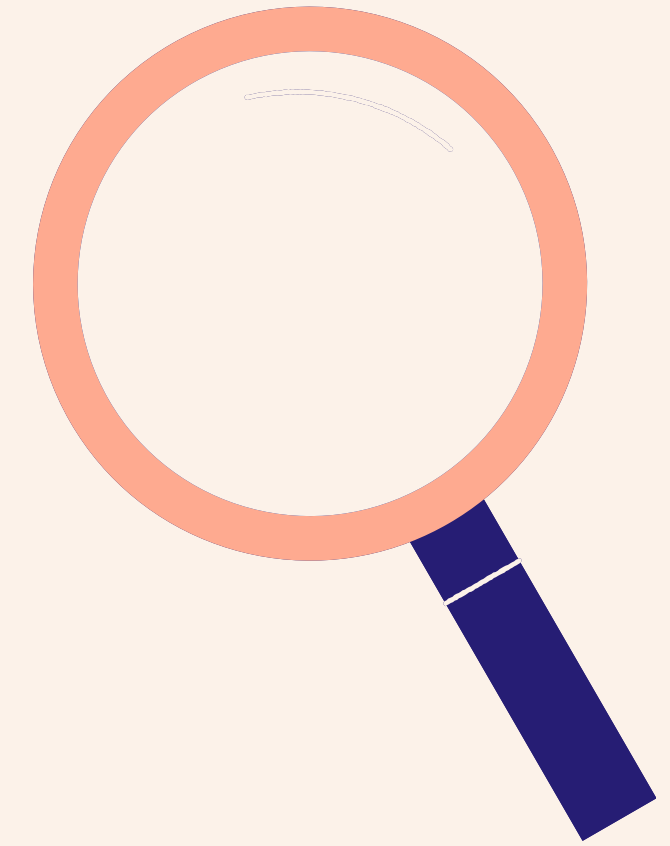
An open mindset means being receptive to new ideas.

It is an approach to learning new things, especially those that challenge our preconceived notions. Being open-minded is also being willing to admit we don't know everything, but we can keep learning.



02

Looking for Evidence and Reasoning



Critical thinkers look at the bigger picture when trying to understand a concept.

To do this, they must know how to find reliable and factual information. Comprehensive research techniques help us find relevant information, synthesize it, and make informed conclusions about a topic.

03

Recognizing Bias



Students should understand that we bring our own prejudices and biases to every decision we make.

It is important to be aware of them and how they influence us. We must not only recognize our own biases, but also that of the authors and creators of the information we consume.



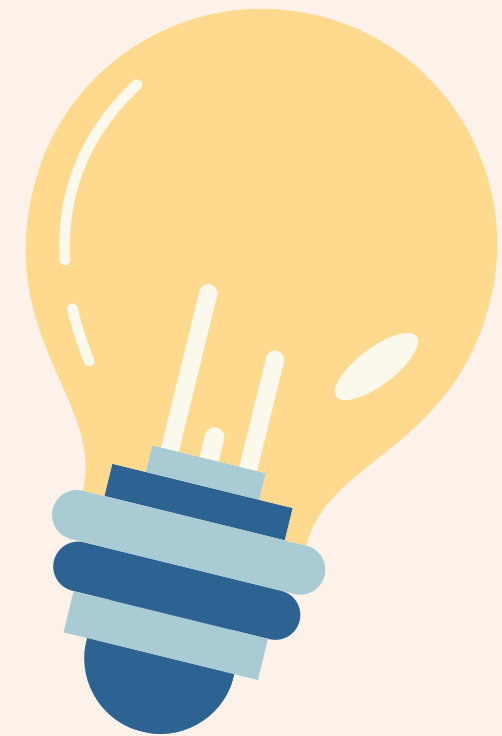
04

Striving for Understanding



Critical thinkers strive for in-depth and meaningful understanding.

They gather and assess information that is supported by evidence or reasoned argument. The goal isn't to find one correct answer, but to have comprehensive knowledge of a topic.



Your Turn



Which of the four characteristics do you think is the most important?

Place the checkmark next to your answer.



Having an Open Mindset

Looking for Evidence and Reasoning

Recognizing Bias

Striving for Understanding

Importance of Critical Thinking

- Increases confidence in our ability to analyze and evaluate information
 - Helps us make informed decisions, problem solve, and cope with challenges
 - Empowers us to trust the choices and decisions we make
 - Aids us in adapting to changes more effectively and positively
 - Challenges our own assumptions and the assumptions of those around us
- What would you add to this list? (Type your answer here).





Skill Development



Critical thinking is a skill that we can continually develop by:

- Asking questions
- Examining the information we consume
- Actively listening
- Researching
- Developing media literacy skills
- Seeking diverse ideas



Asking Questions

Questions help us clarify what we are trying to understand.

They can also increase our curiosity and desire to learn. We should be clear about the information we consume and understand its purpose and significance.

Examining the Information We Consume

Students need to be aware that we are constantly subjected to media.

The information presented influences our decisions and choices. We need to be critical when engaging with media. We should examine information by seeking multiple sources that can verify its accuracy.





Actively Listening

When discussing a topic, be fully engaged and present.

We tend to start formulating responses in our head while someone else is talking, thus missing out on understanding another person's point of view and their reasoning behind it.

Researching

Read, discuss, and observe information related to your topic.

The more you research, the more knowledge you will possess to support your ideas and arguments. Engaging with what we learn will also help us comprehend and retain that information.





Developing Media Literacy Skills

Media literacy involves knowing how to navigate online environments.

This includes finding credible information and understanding the messages and viewpoints being presented. By evaluating the media we consume and create, we can develop a more comprehensive understanding of relevant and balanced information.

Seeking Diverse Ideas

We tend to pursue and trust the opinions and ideas that most align with our own.

This is often referred to as confirmation bias or living in an echo chamber. To have a balanced understanding of a topic, it is important to look at various perspectives and remain objective.





LET'S APPLY OUR
LEARNING

Multiple Choice Question



What is critical thinking?

Drag and drop your answer here

A. Thinking based on assumptions.

B. Thinking outside the box.

C. Using one source of information to reach a conclusion.

D. The ability to analyze information objectively using reliable evidence.

Open Response Question # 1



If you see a news story on social media, what can you do to determine if the information is credible?



Write your response here.

Open Response Question # 2

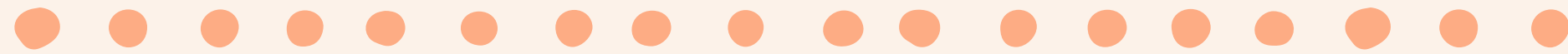


What does it mean when the term “echo chamber” is used when referring to an online environment?

Write your response here.



Ask Yourself



1. Do you question the authenticity of information you see on social media? (Place the checkmark next to your answer).



Yes

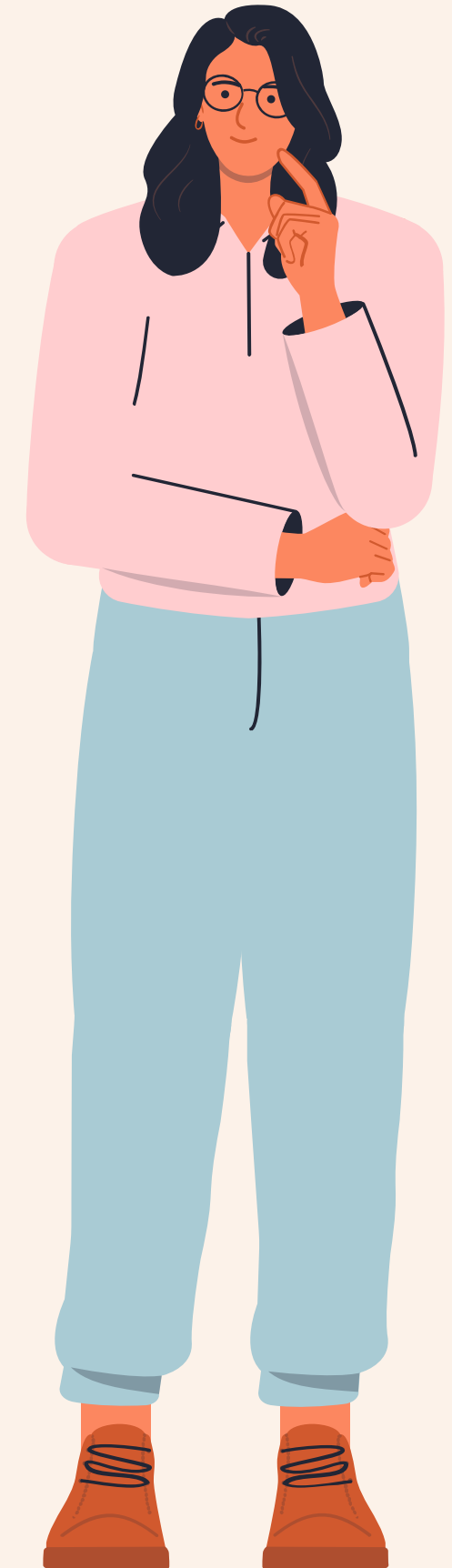
No

2. Have you ever shared a post or video that you found out later was misinformation? (Place the checkmark next to your answer).



Yes

No



Final Thoughts



Critical thinking can be beneficial to you in all aspects and at all stages of life.

Our assumptions, wishful thinking, and self-interests can be barriers to finding and understanding the information we consume. Remember, the goal is to broaden our knowledge and find meaning in what we learn.



Multiple Choice Question



What is critical thinking?

D. The ability to analyze information objectively using reliable evidence.

A. Thinking based on assumptions.

B. Thinking outside the box.

C. Using one source of information to reach a conclusion.

Open Response Question # 1



If you see a news story on social media, what can you do to determine if the information is credible?



Possible answers:

Check their sources. Find other reputable news outlets covering the same story and compare. Ask yourself (1) who benefits from the article (2) who is paying for it, (3) is the article stating facts or opinions?

Open Response Question # 2



What does it mean when the term “echo chamber” is used when referring to an online environment?

Possible answer:

The echo chamber refers to surrounding yourself with people and media that reflects and reinforces your own ideas and interests.



Resources

